

Incident Management & Escalation

Department:	Operations	Document Owner:	Operations Director
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1. Purpose

Establish a consistent framework for identifying, logging, prioritizing, and resolving operational incidents to minimize business impact.

2. Scope

All IT and operational incidents affecting business services, systems, or customers.

3. Procedure

Step 1: Incident Detection & Logging

Any employee may report an incident via the ITSM portal, phone, or monitoring alert. Help desk logs: description, affected systems, business impact, reporter contact. Assign unique incident ID. Initial response within SLA based on priority.

Step 2: Incident Classification

Classify severity: P1 (Critical - service down, >50 users affected), P2 (High - degraded service), P3 (Medium - minor impact), P4 (Low - cosmetic/informational). Wrong classification can be appealed to service desk manager.

Step 3: Investigation & Diagnosis

Assign to appropriate technical team within SLA. Gather logs, run diagnostics, and identify root cause. Document findings in ticket every 30 minutes for P1/P2. Notify stakeholders per communication plan.

Step 4: Escalation Procedure

P1: Escalate to On-Call Manager within 15 min if not resolved. P2: Escalate after 2 hours. Notify VP of Operations for P1 incidents affecting customers. Engage vendor support if internal resolution not possible within SLA.

Step 5: Resolution & Recovery

Implement fix using approved change management process if production change required. Validate resolution with affected users. Restore service and confirm monitoring shows green. Update ticket with resolution steps.

Step 6: Post-Incident Review

P1 incidents require PIR within 5 business days. P2 incidents require PIR within 10 business days. PIR includes: timeline, root cause, contributing factors, and action items. Track action items in ITSM to closure.

4. References & Related Documents

- Change Management Policy OPS-002
- SLA Matrix 2024
- On-Call Roster (internal)

5. Revision History

Version	Date	Description of Change
5.2	2024-03-01	Updated P1 escalation timeline
5.1	2023-07-01	Added PIR requirements
5.0	2023-01-01	Full process redesign